

THE SEARCH AFTER 2

HAPPINESS
A TALE BY
CHARLOTTE
BRONTË

PRINTED BY HERSELF
AND

SOLD BY
NOBODY &c &c &c

AUGUST
THE
SEVENTEENTH



EIGHTEEN HUNDRED

AND ONE

~~TWENTY-EIGHT~~

Twenty nine

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AFTER HAPPINESS [SIC]: A TALE ***

Transcriber's note

This e-book has been transcribed from the author's hand-written manuscript, downloaded from the British Library. The original text and the pagination have both been retained. For the reader's convenience an [edited version](#) follows, where punctuation, capitalisation and spelling have been normalised.

The following changes have been made to both the original and the edited version:

Leaf numbers, as they appear in the original, are shown in [brackets].

The name "ODonell" was changed to "O'Donell".

Ampersand (&) was changed to "and".

The leaf numbers link to the original scans.

The Search after Happiness

The Search after Happiness

[\[1\]](#)

A Tale by C
Bronte

August the seventeenth 1829

THE SEARCH AFTER
HAPINESS

[2]

A TALE BY
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BRONTE

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AUGUST
THE
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Preface

The persons meant by the Chief of the city and his Sons are the Duke of Wellington the Marquis of Duro and Lord Wellesly the city is the Glass town Henry O'Donnell and Alexander Delancy are Captain Tarry-not-at-home and Monsieur Like-to-live-in-lonely-places

Charlotte Bronte

August the 17
1829

A TALE BY

CB July 28 1829

The search after happiness

chapter I

NOT many years ago there lived in a certain city a person of the name of Henry O'Donell, in figure he was tall of a dark complexion and searching black eye, his mind was strong and unbending his disposition uncouth and though respected by many he was loved by few. the city where he resided was very great and magnificent it was governed by a warrior a mighty man of valour whose deeds had resounded to the ends of the earth. this soldier had 2 son's who were at that time of the separate age's of 6 and 7 years Henry—O'Donell was a nobleman of great consequence in the city and a peculiar favourite with the governor before whose glance his stern mind would bow and at his command O'Donell's self will would be overcome and while playing with the young princes he would forget his usual sullenness of demeanour the days of his childhood returned upon him and he would be as merry as the youngest who was gay indeed. one day at court a quarrel ensued between him and another noble words came to blows and O'Donell struck his opponent a violent blow on the left cheek at this the military King started up and commanded O'Donell to apologize this he immediately did, but from that hour the spell of discontent seemed to have been cast over him and he resolved to quit the city. the evening before he put this resolution into practice he had an interview with the King and returned quite an altered man. before he seemed stern and intractable now he was only meditative and sorrowful as he was passing the inner court of the palace he perceived the 2 young princes at play he called them and they came running to him. I am going far from this city and shall most likely never see you again said O'Donell. where are you going? I cannot tell then why do you go away from us why do you go from your own house and

lands from this great and splendid city to you know not where because I am not happy here. And if you are not happy here where you have every thing for which you can wish do you expect to be happy when you are dying of hunger or thirst in a desert or longing for the society of men when you are thousands of miles from any human being. how do you know that that will be my case? it is very likely that it will. and if it was I am determined to go. take this then that you may sometimes remember when you dwell with only the wild beast of the desert or the great eagle of the mountain, said they as they each gave him a curling lock of their hair yes I will take it my princes and I shall remember you and the mighty warrior King your father even when the angel of Death has stretched forth his bony arm against me and I am within the confines of his dreary kingdom the cold damp grave replied O'Donell as the tears rushed to his eyes and he once more embraced the little princes and then quitted them it might be for ever

CHAPTER. THE II

THE Dawn of the next morning found O'Donell on the summit of a High mountain which overlooked the city he had stopped to take a farewell view of the place of his nativity. all along the eastern horizon there was a rich glowing light which as it rose gradually melted into the pale blue of the sky in which just over the light there was still visible the silver crescent of the moon in a short time the sun began to rise in golden glory casting his splendid radiance over all the face of nature and illuminating the magnificent city in the midst of which towering in silent grandeur there appeared the Palace where dwelt the mighty Prince of that great and beautiful city. all around the brazen gates and massive walls of which there flowed the majestic stream of the Guadima whose Banks were bordered by splendid palaces and magnificent gardens behind these stretching for many a league were fruitful plains and forests whose shade seemed almost impenetrable to a single ray of light while in the distance blue mountains were seen raising their heads to the sky and forming a misty girdle to the plains of Dahomey. on the whole of this grand and beautiful prospect O'Donell's gaze was long and fixed but his last look was to the palace [4]

of the King and a tear stood in his eye as he said earnestly may he be preserved from all evil may good attend him and may the chief Geni spread their broad shield of protection over him all the time of his sojourn in this wearisome world. then turning round he began to descend the mountain he pursued his way till the sun began to wax hot when he stopped and sitting down he took out some provisions which he had brought with him and which consisted of a few biscuits and dates while he was eating a tall man came up and accosted him O'Donnell requested him to sit beside him and offered him a biscuit this he refused and taking one out of a small bag which he carried he sat down and they began to talk. In the course of conversation O'Donnell learnt that this mans name was Alexander DeLancy that he was a native of France and that he was engaged in the same pursuit with himself i-e the search of happiness they talked for along time and at last agreed to travel together then rising they pursued their journey towards night fall they lay down in the open air and slept soundly till morning when they again set off and thus they continued till the 3 day when about 2 hours after noon they approached an old castle which they entered and as they were examining it they discovered a subterraneous passage which they could not see the end of Let us follow where this passage leads us and perhaps we may find happiness here said O'Donnell DeLancy agreed the 2 stepped into the opening immediately they a great stone was rolled to the mouth of the passage with a noise like thunder which shut out all but a single ray daylight. "What is that! exclaimed O'Donnell "I cannot tell," replied DeLancy "but never mind I suppose it is only some genius playing tricks" "Well it may be so returned O'Donnell and they proceeded on their way after traveling for a long time as near as they could reckon about 2 days they perceived a silvery streak of light on the walls of the passage something like the light of the moon in a short time they came to the end of the passage and leaping out of the opening which formed they entered a new world they where at first so much bewildered by the different objects which struck their senses that they almost fainted but at length recovering they had time to see every thing around them they were upon the top of a rock which was more than a thousand fathoms high, all beneath them was liquid Mountains tossed to and fro with horrible confusion roaring and raging with a tremendous noise and crowned with waves of foam all above them was a mighty firmament in one part covered with black clouds from which darted huge and terrible sheets of Lightning in another part an immense globe of

Light like silver was hanging in the sky and several smaller globes which sparkled exceedingly surrounded it. In a short time the tempest which was dreadful beyond description ceased the large black clouds cleared away the silver globes vanished and another globe whose light was of a gold colour appeared it was far larger than the former and in a little time it became so intensely bright that they could no longer gaze on it so after looking around them for some time they rose and pursued their journey. They had travelled a long way when they came to an immense forest the trees of which bore a large fruit of a deep purple colour of which they tasted and found that it was fit for food, they journeyed in this forest for three days and on the 3 day they entered a valley or rather a deep glen surrounded on each side by tremendous rocks whose tops were lost in the clouds in this glen they continued for some time and at last came in sight of a mountain which rose so high that they could not see the summit though the sky was quite clear. At the foot of the mountain there flowed a river of pure water bordered by trees which had flowers of a beautiful rose colour except these trees nothing was to be seen but black forests and huge rocks rising out of a wilderness which bore the terrible aspect of devastation and which stretched as far as the eye could reach in this desolate land no sound was to be heard, not even cry of the eagle or the scream of the Curlew but a silence like the silence of the grave reigned over all the face of nature unbroken except by the murmur of the river as it slowly wound its course through the desert

[5]

CHAPTER THE III

after they had contemplated this scene for some time O'Donnell exclaimed "ALEXANDER Let us abide here what need have we to travel father let us make this our place of rest"! "We will" replied DeLancy and "this shall be our abode" added he pointing to a cave at the foot of the mountain "It shall" returned—O'Donnell as they entered it. In this country they remained for many long years and passed their time in a manner which made them completely happy sometimes they would sit upon a high rock and listen to the hoarse thunder rolling through the sky and making the mountains to echo and the deserts to ring with its awful voice, sometimes they would

watch the lightning darting across black clouds and shivering huge fragments of rock in its terrible passage sometimes they would witness the great glorious orb of gold sink behind the far distant mountains which girded the horizon and then watch the advance of grey twilight and the little stars coming forth in beauty and the silver moon arising in her splendour till the cold dews of night began to fall and then they would retire to their bed in the cave with hearts full of joy and thankfulness. one evening they were seated in this cave by a large Blazing fire of turf which cast its lurid light to the high arched roof and illuminated the tall and stately pillars cut by the hand of nature out the stony rock with a cheerful and red glare that appeared strange in this desolate land which no fires had ever before visited except those fierce flames of death which flash from the heavens when robed in the dreadful majesty of thunder. they were seated in this cave then listening to the howling night wind as it swept in mournful cadences through the trees of the forest which encircled the foot of the mount and bordered the stream which flowed round it. they were quite silent and their thoughts were occupied by those that were afar off and whom it was their fate most likely never more to behold O'Donnell was thinking of his noble master and his young Princes of the thousands of miles which intervened between him and them and the sad silent tear gushed forth as he ruminated on the happiness of those times when his master frowned not when the gloom of care gave place to the smile of friendship when he would talk to him and laugh with him and be to him not as a brother no no but as a mighty warrior who relaxing from his haughtiness would now and then converse with his high officers in a strain of vivacity and playful humour not to be equalled. next he viewed him in his mind's eye at the head of his army he heard in the ears of his imagination the buzz of expectation of hope and supposition which humed round him as his penetrating eye with a still keenness of expression was fixed on the distant ranks of the enemy then he heard his authoritative voice exclaim, Onward brave sons of freedom onward to the battle and lastly his parting words to him "in prosperity or, in misery In sorrow or in joy In populous cities or in desolate wildernesses my prayer shall go with you" darted across his mind with such painful distinctness that he at length gave way to his uncontrollable grief at the thought that he should never behold his beloved and mighty commander more and burst into a flood of tears. What is the matter Henry exclaimed Delancy O nothing nothing was the reply and they were resuming their tacit thinking

when a voice was heard outside the cavern which broke strangely upon the desolate silence of that land which for thousands of years had heard no sound save the howling of the wind through the forest the echoing of the thunder among mountains or the solitary murmuring of the river if we except the presence of O'Donell and Delancy. Listen! cried ALEXANDER listen! what is that. it is the sound of a mans voice replied Henry and then snatching up a burning torch he rushed to the mouth of the cave followed by Delancy when they had got there they saw the figure of a very old man sitting on the damp wet ground moaning and complaining bitterly they went up to him at their approach he rose and said are you human or supernatural beings? they assured him that they were human. he went on. then why have you taken up your abode in this land of the grave? O'Donell answered that he would relate to him all the particulars if he would he would take shelter for the night with them the old man consented and when they were all assembled round the cheerful fire O'Donell fulfilled his promise and then requested the old man to tell them how he came to be travelling there he complied and began as follows——

[6]

CHAPTER the IV

I was the son of a respectable merchant in moussoul my father intended to bring me up to his own trade but I was idle and did not like. it one day as I was playing in the street a very old man came up to me and asked me if I would go with him I asked him where he was going he replied that if I would go with him he would show me very wonderful things this raised my curiosity and I consented he immediately took me by the hand and hurried me out of the city of Moussoul so quickly that my breath was almost stopped and it seemed as if we glided along in the air for I could hear no sound of our footsteps we continued on our course for a long time till we came to glen surrounded by very high mountains how we passed over those mountains I could never tell, in the middle of the glen there was a small fountain of very clear water my conductor directed me to drink of it this I did and immediately I found myself in a palace the glory of which far exceeds any description which I can give the tall stately pillars reaching from

heaven to earth were formed of the finest and purest diamonds the pavement sparkling with gold and precious stones and the mighty dome made solemn and awful by its stupendous magnitude was of a single emerald. in the midst of this grand and magnificent palace was a lamp like the sun the radiance of which made all the palace to flash and glitter with an almost fearful grandeur the ruby sent a stream forth of crimson light the topaz gold the sapphire intensest purple and the dome poured a flood of deep clear splendour which overcame all the other gaudy lights by its mild triumphant glory in this palace were thousands and tens of thousands of faeries and geni some of whom flitted lightly among the blazing lamps to the sound of unearthly music which dyed and swelled in a strain of wild grandeur suited to the words they sung—

in this fairy land of light
no mortal ere has been
and the dreadful grandeur of this sight
by them hath not been seen

t'would strike them shuddering to the earth
like the flash from a thunder cloud
it would quench their light and joyous mirth
and fit them for the shroud

the rising of our palaces
like visions of the deep
and the glory of their structure
no mortal voice can speak

the music of our songs
and our mighty trumpets swell
and the sounding of our silver harps
no mortal tongue can tell

of us they know but little
save when the storm doth rise
and the mighty waves are tossing
against the arched skys

then oft they see us striding
o'er the billows snow white foam [\[7\]](#)
or hear us speak in thunder
when we stand in grandeur lone

on the darkest of the mighty clouds
which veil the pearly moon
around us lightning flashing
nights blackness to illumine

chorus the music of our songs

and our mighty trumpets
swell and the sounding of our silver
harp no mortal tongue can tell

when they had finished their was a dead silence for about half an hour and then the palace began slowly and gradually to vanish till it disappeared intirely and I found myself in the glen surrounded by high mountains the fountain illuminated by the cold light of the moon springing up in the middle of the valley and standing close by was the old man who had conducted me to this enchanted place he turned round and I could see that his countenance had an expression of strange severity which I had not before observed. Follow me he said I obeyed and we began to ascend the mountain it would be needless to trouble you with a repititon of all my adventures suffice it to say that after two months time we arrived at a large temple we entred it the interior as well as the outside had a very gloomy and ominous aspect being intirely built of black marble the old man suddenly seized me and dragged me to an altar at the upper end of the temple then forcing me down on my knees he made me swear that I would be his servant forever and this promise I faithfully kept notwithstanding the dreadful scenes of magic of which every day of my life I was forced to be a witness one day he told me that he would discharge me from the oath I had taken and comanded me to leave his service I obeyed and after wandering about the world for many years I one evening laid myself down on a little bank by the roadside intending to pass the night there suddenly I felt myself raised in the air by invisible hands in a short time I lost sight of the earth and continued on my course through the clouds till I became insensible and when I recovered from my swoon I found myself lying outside this cave what may be my future destiny I know not——

CHAPTER the V

When the old man had finished his tale O'Donell and Delancy thanked him for the relation adding at the same time that they had never heard anything half so wonderful then as it was very late they all retired to rest next morning O'Donell awoke very early and looking round the cave he perceived the bed of leaves on which the old man had lain to be empty the

rising he went out of the cave the sky was covered with red fiery clouds except those in the east whose edges were tinged with the bright rays of the morning sun as they strove to hide its glory with their dark veil of vapours now all beauty and radiance by the golden line of light which streaked their gloomy surface beneath this storm portending sky and far off to the westward rose two tremendous rocks whose sumits were enveloped with black clouds rolling one above another with an awful magnificence well suited to the land of wilderness and mountain which they canopied gliding along in the air between these two rocks was a chariot of light and in the chariot sat a figure the expression of whose countenance was that of the old man armed with the majesty and might of a spirit O'Donell stood at the mouth of the cave watching it till it vanished and then calling Delancy he related the circumstance to him some years after this ALEXander went out one morning in search of the fruit on which they subsisted noon [8] came and he had not returned evening and still no tidings of him O'Donell began to be alarmed and set out in search of him but could nowhere find him one whole day he spent in wandering about the rocks and mountains and in the evening he came back to his cave weary and faint with hunger and thirst days weeks months passed away and no Delancy appeared O'Donell might now be said to be truly miserable he would sit on a rock for hours together and cry out ALEXander ALEXander but receive no answer except the distant echoing of his voice among the rocks sometimes he fancied it was another person answering him and he would listen earnestly till it died away then sinking into utter despair again he would sit till the dews of night began to fall when he would retire to his cave to pass the night in unquiet broken slumbers or in thinking of his beloved commander whom he could never see more in one of these dreadful intervals he took up a small parcel and opening it he saw lying before him two locks of soft curly hair shining like—burnished gold he gazed on them for a little and thought of the words of those who gave them to him—take this then that you may remember us when you dwell with only the wild beast of the desert and the great eagle of the mountain he burst into a flood of tears he wrung his hands sorrow and in the anguish of the moment he wished that he could once more see them and the mighty Warrior King their father if it cost him his life just at that instant a loud clap of thunder shook the roof of the cave a sound like the rushing of the wind was heard and a mighty genius stood before him I know thy wish cried he with a loud and terrible voice and I

will grant it in 2 months time thou returnest to the castle wence thou camest hither and surrenderest thyself into my power O'Donell promised that he would and instantly he found himself at the door of the old castle and in the land of his birth he pursued his journey for three days and on the 3. day he arrived at the mountain which overlooked the city it was a beautiful evening in the month of September and the full moon was shedding her traquil light on all the face of nature the city was lying in its splendour and magnificence surrounded by the broad stream of the Guadima the palace was majestically towering in the midst of it and all its pillars and battlements eemed in the calm light of the moon as if they were transformed into siver by the touch of a fairys wand O'Donell staid not long to contemplate this beautiful scene but decending the mountain he soon crossed the fertile plain which led to the city and entering the gates he quickly arrived at the palace without speaking to any one he entred the iner court of the palace by a seecret way with which he was acquainted and then going up a flight of steps and crossing a long gallery he arrived at the Kings private apartment the door was half open he looked and beheld 2 very handsome young men sitting together and reading he instantly recogized them and was going to step forward when the door opened and the Great Duke entred O'Donell could contain himself no longer but rushing in he threw himself at the feet of his Grace O'Donell is this you exclaimed the Duke it is my most noble master answered O'Donell almost choking with joy the young princes instantly embraced him while he almost smothered them with caresses after a while they became tranquil and then O'Donell at the request of the Duke related all his adventures since he [9] parted with them not omiting the condition on which he was now in the palace when he had ended a loud voice was heard saying that he was free from his promise and might spend the rest of his days in his native city sometime after this as O'Donell was walking in the streets he met a gentleman who he thought he had seen before but could not recolect where or under what circumstances after a little conversation he discovered that he was ALEXander Delancy that he was now a rich merchant in the city of Paris and high in favour with the emperor Napoleon as may be suposed they both were equally delighted at the discovery they ever after lived hapily in their seperate cities and so ends my little tale.

C Bronte August the 17
1829

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FINIS

EDITED VERSION

Preface

The persons meant by the Chief of the city and his Sons are the Duke of Wellington, the Marquis of Duro and Lord Wellesly. The city is the Glass town. Henry O'Donell and Alexander Delancy are Captain Tarry-not-at-home and Monsieur Like-to-live-in-lonely-places.

Charlotte Bronte

August the 17 1829

[3]

A TALE BY

CB July 28 1829

The search after happiness

Chapter I

NOT many years ago there lived in a certain city a person of the name of Henry O'Donell. In figure he was tall, of a dark complexion and searching black eye, his mind was strong and unbending, his disposition unsociable and though respected by many he was loved by few. The city where he resided was very great and magnificent. It was governed by a warrior, a mighty man of valour whose deeds had resounded to the ends of the earth. This soldier had two sons who were at that time of the separate ages of six and seven years.

Henry O'Donell was a nobleman of great consequence in the city and a peculiar favourite with the governor, before whose glance his stern mind would bow and at his command O'Donell's selfwill would be overcome, and

while playing with the young princes he would forget his usual sullenness of demeanour; the days of his childhood returned upon him and he would be as merry as the youngest, who was gay indeed.

One day at court, a quarrel ensued between him and another noble, words came to blows and O'Donell struck his opponent a violent blow on the left cheek. At this the military King started up and commanded O'Donell to apologize. This he immediately did, but from that hour the spell of discontent seemed to have been cast over him and he resolved to quit the city. The evening before he put this resolution into practice, he had an interview with the King and returned quite an altered man. Before he seemed stern and intractable, now he was only meditative and sorrowful. As he was passing the inner court of the palace, he perceived the two young princes at play. He called them and they came running to him.

"I am going far from this city and shall most likely never see you again," said O'Donell.

"Where are you going?"

"I cannot tell."

"Then why do you go away from us, why do you go from your own house and lands, from this great and splendid city to you know not where?"

"Because I am not happy here."

"And if you are not happy here where you have every thing for which you can wish, do you expect to be happy when you are dying of hunger or thirst in a desert or longing for the society of men, when you are thousands of miles, of miles from any human being?"

"How do you know that that will be my case?"

"It is very likely that it will."

"And if it was, I am determined to go."

"Take this then that you may sometimes remember us when you dwell with only the wild beast of the desert or the great eagle of the mountain," said they as they each gave him a curling lock of their hair.

"Yes, I will take it my princes and I shall remember you and the mighty warrior King your father, even when the angel of Death has stretched forth

his bony arm against me and I am within the confines of his dreary kingdom, the cold damp grave," replied O'Donell, as the tears rushed to his eyes and he once more embraced the little princes and then quitted them, it might be for ever——

CHAPTER THE II

THE Dawn of the next morning found O'Donell on the summit of a high mountain which overlooked the city. He had stopped to take a farewell view of the place of his nativity. All along the eastern horizon, there was a rich glowing light, which, as it rose, gradually melted into the pale blue of the sky, in which, just over the light, there was still visible the silver crescent of the moon. In a short time the sun began to rise in golden glory casting his splendid radiance over all the face of nature and illuminating the magnificent city in the midst of which, towering in the silent grandeur, there appeared the Palace where dwelt the mighty Prince of that great and beautiful city, all around the brazen gates and massive walls of which there flowed the majestic stream of the Guadima whose banks were bordered by splendid palaces and magnificent gardens. Behind these stretching for many a league were fruitful plains and forests whose shade seemed almost impenetrable to a single ray of light, while in the distance blue mountains were seen raising their heads to the sky and forming a misty girdle to the plains of Dahomey. On the whole of this grand and beautiful prospect, O'Donell's gaze was long and fixed but his last look was to the palace ^[4] of the King and a tear stood in his eye as he said earnestly, "May he be preserved from all evil. May good attend him and may the chief Genie spread their broad shield of protection over him all the time of his sojourn in this wearisome world."

Then turning round he began to descend the mountain. He pursued his way till the sun began to wax hot when he stopped and, sitting down, he took out some provisions which he had brought with him and which consisted of a few biscuits and dates. While he was eating, a tall man came up and accosted him. O'Donell requested him to sit beside him and offered him a biscuit. This he refused, and taking one out of a small bag which he carried, he sat down and they began to talk. In the course of conversation O'Donell

learnt that this man's name was Alexander Delancy, that he was a native of France, and that he was engaged in the same pursuit with himself, i.e. the search of happiness. They talked for a long time and at last agreed to travel together. Then, rising, they pursued their journey. Towards nightfall they lay down in the open air and slept soundly till morning, when they again set off and thus they continued till the 3rd day, when about two hours after noon they approached an old castle which they entered and as they were examining it, they discovered a subterraneous passage, which they could not see the end of.

"Let us follow where this passage leads us and perhaps we may find happiness here," said O'Donell.

Delancy agreed; the two stepped into the opening. Immediately a great stone was rolled to the mouth of the passage with a noise like thunder which shut out all but a single ray of daylight.

"What is that!" exclaimed O'Donell.

"I cannot tell," replied Delancy "but never mind. I suppose it is only some genius playing tricks."

"Well, it may be so," returned O'Donell and they proceeded on their way.

After travelling for a long time, as near as they could reckon about two days, they perceived a silvery streak of light on the walls of the passage, something like the light of the moon. In a short time they came to the end of the passage, and, leaping out of the opening which formed, they entered a new world.

They were at first so much bewildered by the different objects which struck their senses that they almost fainted, but at length recovering they had time to see everything around them. They were upon the top of a rock which was more than a thousand fathoms high. All beneath them was liquid mountains tossed to and fro with horrible confusion, roaring and raging with a tremendous noise and crowned with waves of foam. All above them was a mighty firmament, in one part covered with black clouds from which darted huge and terrible sheets of lightning, in another part an immense globe of light like silver was hanging in the sky and several smaller globes which sparkled exceedingly surrounded it.

In a short time the tempest which was dreadful beyond description ceased, the large black clouds cleared away, the silver globes vanished, and another globe whose light was of a gold colour appeared. It was far larger than the former and in a little time it became so intensely bright that they could no longer gaze on it, so after looking around them for some time they rose and pursued their journey.

They had travelled a long way, when they came to an immense forest, the trees of which bore a large fruit of a deep purple colour of which they tasted and found that it was fit for food. They journeyed in this forest for three days and on the 3rd day they entered a valley or rather a deep glen surrounded on each side by tremendous rocks, whose tops were lost in the clouds. In this glen they continued for some time and at last came in sight of a mountain which rose so high that they could not see the summit though the sky was quite clear. At the foot of the mountain, there flowed a river of pure water bordered by trees which had flowers of a beautiful rose colour. Except these trees nothing was to be seen but black forests and huge rocks rising out of a wilderness which bore the terrible aspect of devastation and which stretched as far as the eye could reach. In this desolate land no sound was to be heard, not even cry of the eagle or the scream of the curlew, but a silence, like the silence of the grave, reigned over all the face of nature unbroken except by the murmur of the river as it slowly wound its course through the desert.

[5]

CHAPTER THE III

After they had contemplated this scene for some time O'Donell exclaimed, "Alexander, let us abide here. What need have we to travel farther? let us make this our place of rest!"

"We will," replied Delancy "and this shall be our abode," added he pointing to a cave at the foot of the mountain.

"It shall," returned O'Donell as they entered it.

In this country they remained for many long years and passed their time in a manner which made them completely happy. Sometimes they would sit upon a high rock and listen to the hoarse thunder rolling through the sky and making the mountains to echo and the deserts to ring with its awful voice. Sometimes they would watch the lightning darting across black clouds and shivering huge fragments of rock in its terrible passage. Sometimes they would witness the great glorious orb of gold sink behind the far distant mountains which girded the horizon and then watch the advance of grey twilight and the little stars coming forth in beauty and the silver moon arising in her splendour till the cold dews of night began to fall and then they would retire to their bed in the cave with hearts full of joy and thankfulness.

One evening they were seated in this cave by a large blazing fire of turf which cast its lurid light to the high arched roof and illuminated the tall and stately pillars cut by the hand of nature out the stony rock with a cheerful and red glare that appeared strange in this desolate land, which no fires had ever before visited except those fierce flames of death, which flash from the heavens when robed in the dreadful majesty of thunder. They were seated in this cave then listening to the howling night wind as it swept in mournful cadences through the trees of the forest, which encircled the foot of the mount and bordered the stream which flowed round it. They were quite silent and their thoughts were occupied by those that were afar off and whom it was their fate most likely never more to behold. O'Donnell was thinking of his noble master and his young Princes, of the thousands of miles which intervened between him and them, and the sad silent tear gushed forth as he ruminated on the happiness of those times: when his master frowned, not when the gloom of care gave place to the smile of friendship; when he would talk to him and laugh with him and be to him not as a brother, no no, but as a mighty warrior, who relaxing from his haughtiness would now and then converse with his high officers in a strain of vivacity and playful humour not to be equalled. Next he viewed him in his mind's eye at the head of his army. He heard in the ears of his imagination the buzz of expectation of hope and supposition which hummed round him as his penetrating eye with a still keenness of expression was fixed on the distant ranks of the enemy, then he heard his authoritative voice exclaim, "Onward brave sons of freedom, onward to the battle," and lastly his parting words to him, "In prosperity or in misery, in

sorrow or in joy, in populous cities or in desolate wildernesses my prayer shall go with you," darted across his mind with such painful distinctness that he at length gave way to his uncontrollable grief at the thought that he should never behold his beloved and mighty commander more and burst into a flood of tears.

"What is the matter, Henry?" exclaimed Delancy.

"O nothing, nothing," was the reply, and they were resuming their tacit thinking, when a voice was heard outside the cavern which broke strangely upon the desolate silence of that land which for thousands of years had heard no sound save the howling of the wind through the forest, the echoing of the thunder among mountains or the solitary murmuring of the river if we except the presence of O'Donell and Delancy.

"Listen!" cried Alexander, "listen! What is that?"

"It is the sound of a man's voice," replied Henry and then snatching up a burning torch, he rushed to the mouth of the cave followed by Delancy.

When they had got there they saw the figure of a very old man, sitting on the damp wet ground moaning and complaining bitterly. They went up to him.

At their approach he rose and said, "Are you human or supernatural beings?"

They assured him that they were human. He went on, "Then why have you taken up your abode in this land of the grave?"

O'Donell answered that he would relate to him all the particulars, if he would he would take shelter for the night with them. The old man consented and when they were all assembled round the cheerful fire, O'Donell fulfilled his promise and then requested the old man to tell them how he came to be travelling there. He complied and began as follows——

[6]

CHAPTER the IV

"I was the son of a respectable merchant in Moussoul. My father intended to bring me up to his own trade but I was idle and did not like it. One day as I was playing in the street a very old man came up to me and asked me if I would go with him. I asked him where he was going. He replied that if I would go with him he would show me very wonderful things. This raised my curiosity and I consented. He immediately took me by the hand and hurried me out of the city of Moussoul so quickly that my breath was almost stopped and it seemed as if we glided along in the air for I could hear no sound of our footsteps. We continued on our course for a long time till we came to a glen surrounded by very high mountains. How we passed over those mountains, I could never tell. In the middle of the glen there was a small fountain of very clear water. My conductor directed me to drink of it. This I did and immediately I found myself in a palace, the glory of which far exceeds any description which I can give: the tall stately pillars reaching from heaven to earth were formed of the finest and purest diamonds, the pavement sparkling with gold and precious stones and the mighty dome, made solemn and awful by its stupendous magnitude, was of a single emerald. In the midst of this grand and magnificent palace was a lamp like the sun, the radiance of which made all the palace to flash and glitter with an almost fearful grandeur, the ruby sent a stream forth of crimson light, the topaz gold, the sapphire intensest purple, and the dome poured a flood of deep clear splendour which overcame all the other gaudy lights by its mild triumphant glory. In this palace were thousands and tens of thousands of fairies and genii, some of whom flitted lightly among the blazing lamps to the sound of unearthly music which died and swelled in a strain of wild grandeur suited to the words they sung—

in this fairy land of light
no mortal ere has been
and the dreadful grandeur of this sight
by them hath not been seen

'twould strike them shuddering to the earth
like the flash from a thunder cloud
it would quench their light and joyous mirth
and fit them for the shroud

the rising of our palaces
like visions of the deep
and the glory of their structure
no mortal voice can speak

the music of our songs
and our mighty trumpets' swell
and the sounding of our silver harps
no mortal tongue can tell

of us they know but little
save when the storm doth rise
and the mighty waves are tossing
against the arched skies

then oft they see us striding
o'er the billows' snow white foam [\[7\]](#)
or hear us speak in thunder
when we stand in grandeur lone

on the darkest of the mighty clouds
which veil the pearly moon
around us lightning flashing
night's blackness to illumine

chorus the music of our songs

and our mighty trumpets' swell
and the sounding of our silver
harp no mortal tongue can tell.

When they had finished, there was a dead silence for about half an hour and then the palace began slowly and gradually to vanish till it disappeared entirely and I found myself in the glen surrounded by high mountains, the fountain illuminated by the cold light of the moon springing up in the middle of the valley, and standing close by was the old man who had conducted me to this enchanted place. He turned round and I could see that his countenance had an expression of strange severity which I had not before observed. "Follow me," he said. I obeyed and we began to ascend the mountain. It would be needless to trouble you with a repetition of all my adventures. Suffice it to say that after two months time, we arrived at a large temple. We entered it. The interior as well as the outside had a very gloomy and ominous aspect being entirely built of black marble. The old man suddenly seized me and dragged me to an altar at the upper end of the temple, then, forcing me down on my knees, he made me swear that I would be his servant forever and this promise I faithfully kept notwithstanding the dreadful scenes of magic of which every day of my life I was forced to be a witness. One day he told me that he would discharge me from the oath I had taken and commanded me to leave his service. I obeyed and, after wandering about the world for many years, I one evening laid myself down on a little bank by the roadside intending to pass the night there. Suddenly I felt myself raised in the air by invisible hands. In a short time I lost sight of the earth and continued on my course through the clouds till I became insensible and when I recovered from my swoon, I found myself lying outside this cave. What may be my future destiny I know not _____"

CHAPTER the V

When the old man had finished his tale, O'Donell and Delancy thanked him for the relation, adding at the same time that they had never heard anything half so wonderful. Then as it was very late, they all retired to rest. Next

morning O'Donell awoke very early and, looking round the cave, he perceived the bed of leaves on which the old man had lain to be empty. He went out of the cave. The sky was covered with the rising red fiery clouds except those in the east whose edges were tinged with the bright rays of the morning sun, as they strove to hide its glory with their dark veil of vapours, now all beauty and radiance by the golden line of light which streaked their gloomy surface. Beneath this storm-portending sky and far off to the westward rose two tremendous rocks whose summits were enveloped with black clouds rolling one above another with an awful magnificence well suited to the land of wilderness and mountain which they canopied. Gliding along in the air between these two rocks was a chariot of light and in the chariot sat a figure, the expression of whose countenance was that of the old man armed with the majesty and might of a spirit. O'Donell stood at the mouth of the cave watching it till it vanished and then calling Delancy he related the circumstance to him.

Some years after this, Alexander went out one morning in search of the fruit on which they subsisted. Noon came and he had not returned, [8] evening and still no tidings of him. O'Donell began to be alarmed and set out in search of him but could nowhere find him. One whole day he spent in wandering about the rocks and mountains and in the evening he came back to his cave weary and faint with hunger and thirst. Days, weeks, months passed away and no Delancy appeared. O'Donell might now be said to be truly miserable. He would sit on a rock for hours together and cry out "Alexander, Alexander," but receive no answer, except the distant echoing of his voice among the rocks. Sometimes he fancied it was another person answering him and he would listen earnestly till it died away. Then sinking into utter despair again, he would sit till the dews of night began to fall, when he would retire to his cave to pass the night in unquiet broken slumbers or in thinking of his beloved commander, whom he could never see more. In one of these dreadful intervals, he took up a small parcel and opening it he saw lying before him two locks of soft curly hair shining like burnished gold. He gazed on them for a little and thought of the words of those who gave them to him—"Take this then, that you may remember us when you dwell with only the wild beast of the desert and the great eagle of the mountain." He burst into a flood of tears, he wrung his hands in sorrow, and in the anguish of the moment he wished that he could once more see them and the mighty Warrior King their father if it cost him his life. Just at

that instant, a loud clap of thunder shook the roof of the cave, a sound like the rushing of the wind was heard and a mighty genius stood before him.

"I know thy wish," cried he with a loud and terrible voice "and I will grant it. In two months' time thou returnest to the castle whence thou camest hither and surrenderest thyself into my power."

O'Donell promised that he would and instantly he found himself at the door of the old castle and in the land of his birth. He pursued his journey for three days and on the third day, he arrived at the mountain which overlooked the city. It was a beautiful evening in the month of September and the full moon was shedding her tranquil light on all the face of nature. The city was lying in its splendour and magnificence surrounded by the broad stream of the Guadima, the palace was majestically towering in the midst of it and all its pillars and battlements seemed in the calm light of the moon as if they were transformed into silver by the touch of a fairy's wand. O'Donell stayed not long to contemplate this beautiful scene but, descending the mountain, he soon crossed the fertile plain which led to the city and entering the gates he quickly arrived at the palace. Without speaking to anyone he entered the inner court of the palace by a secret way with which he was acquainted and then going up a flight of steps and crossing a long gallery he arrived at the King's private apartment.

The door was half open. He looked and beheld two very handsome young men sitting together and reading. He instantly recognized them and was going to step forward, when the door opened and the Great Duke entered. O'Donell could contain himself no longer but, rushing in, he threw himself at the feet of his Grace.

"O'Donell, is this you?" exclaimed the Duke.

"It is, my most noble master," answered O'Donell, almost choking with joy. The young princes instantly embraced him while he almost smothered them with caresses. After a while they became tranquil, and then O'Donell at the request of the Duke related all his adventures since he parted [9] with them not omitting the condition on which he was now in the palace. When he had ended, a loud voice was heard saying that he was free from his promise and might spend the rest of his days in his native city.

Some time after this, as O'Donell was walking in the streets, he met a gentleman who he thought he had seen before but could not recollect where or under what circumstances. After a little conversation, he discovered that he was Alexander Delancy, that he was now a rich merchant in the city of Paris and high in favour with the emperor Napoleon. As may be supposed, they both were equally delighted at the discovery. They ever after lived happily in their separate cities and so ends my little tale.

C Bronte August the 17 1829

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Chap IV Old man's tale

Chap V Departure of the old man—disappearance of Delancy—transportation of O'Donell—his arrival at the city—his arrival at the palace—his interview with his chief—he finds Delancy—end

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE SEARCH
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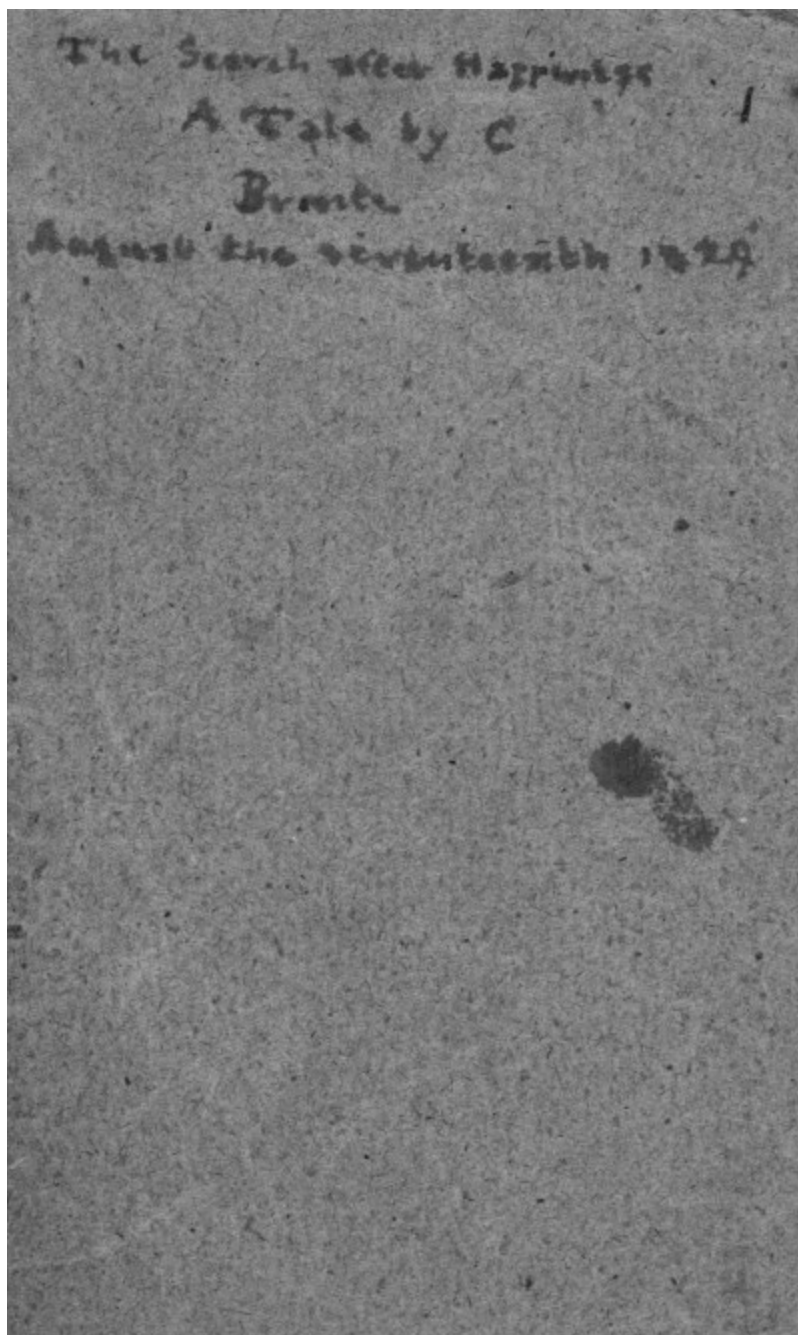
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AUGUST
THE
SEVENTEENTH

~~1848~~
EIGHTEEN HUNDRED

AND ON

~~TWENTY EIGHT~~

Twenty nine

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Preface

The persons nearest by the Chief
of the city & his sons are the
Duke of Wellington the Marquis
of Duns & Lord Mellesley
the city is the Glass town
Henry O'Donnell ~~and~~
and Alexander Delancey are
Captain Tanya not-at-home
& Monsieur Libre-to-live-in-
lonely-places

Charlotte Brontë
August the 17
1829

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A TALE BY 3

The search of CB July 28 1829 for happiness
chapter 1

NOT many years ago there lived in a certain city
a person of the name of Henry O'Donnell, in figure he was
tall of a dark complexion & searching black eye, his mind was
strong & unbending his disposition uncosiable & though res-
pected by many he was loved by few: the city where he re-
sided was very great & magnificent it was governed by a
warrior a mighty man of valour whose deeds had resound-
ed to the ends of the earth. this soldier had a son who were
at that time of the separate ages of 6 & 7 years Henry —
O'Donnell was a nobleman of great consequence in the
city & a peculiar favourite with the governor before whose
glance his stern mind would bow & at his command O'Donnell
self will would be overcome & while playing with the young
princes he would forget his usual sullenness of demeanour
the days of his childhood returned upon him & he would be
as merry as the youngest who was gay indeed. one day
at court a quarrel ensued between him & another noble
words came to blows & O'Donnell struck his opponent a
violent blow on the left cheek at this the military
King started up & commanded O'Donnell to apologise
this he immediately did, but from that hour a spell seem-
ed to have been cast over him & he resolved ~~in his mind~~
to quit the city, the evening before he put this
resolution into practice he had an interview with the
King & returned quite an altered man, before he was
stern & intractable now he was meditative & sorrowful
as he was passing the inner court of the palace he
perceived the 2 young princes at play he called them
& they came running to him. I am going far from this
city & shall most likely never see you again said O'Donnell
where are you going? I cannot tell them why do you go
away from us why do you go from your own house &
lands from this great & splendid city? you know not yet

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because I am not happy here - if you are not happy here where you have every thing for which you can wish do you expect to be happy when you are dying of hunger or thirst in a desert or longing for the society of men when you are thousands of miles of miles from any human being how do you know that that will be my case? It is very likely that it will. Well if it was I am determined to go. Well take that that you may sometimes remember when you dwell with only the wild beasts of the desert or the ~~the~~ of the ~~the~~ said they as they each gave him a curving look at their hair yes I will take it my prince I shall remember you a mighty warrior King your father even when the angel of Death has stretched forth his bony arm against me and I am within the confines of his dreary King dom the cold damp grave replied O'Donnell as the tears rushed to his eyes and he once more embraced the little prince. At then quitted them it might be for ever -

CHAPTER THE II

THE Dawn of the next morning found O'Donnell on the summit of a High mountain which overlooked the city he had stopped to take a farewell view of the place of his nativity. all along the eastern horizon there was a rich glowing light which as it rose gradually melted into a pale blue of the sky in which just over the light there was still in the silver crescent of the moon in a short time the sun began to rise in golden glory casting his splendid radiance over all the face of nature & illuminating the magnificent city in the midst of which towering in silent grandeur there appeared the Palace where dwelt the great the mighty Prince of that great city. all around the brazen gates & massive walls of which there flowed the majestic stream of the Guadima whose Banks were bordered by splendid palaces & magnificent gardens behind them stretching for many a league were fruitful plains & ~~dark~~ forests whose ~~impenetrable~~ shade ~~seemed almost impenetrable to a single ray of light~~ while in the distance blue mountains were seen raising their heads to the sky forming a misty garb to the plains on which ~~Dahomey~~ the whole of this grand and beautiful

O'Donnell gaze was long & fixed but his last look was to the face of the King & a tear stood in his eye as he said earnestly may he be preserved from all evil may good attend him & may the chief Geni spread their broad shield of protection over him. All the time of his sojourn in this wondrous world the turning round he began to descend the mountain he pursued his way till the sun began to wane when he stopped & sitting down he took out some provisions which he had brought with him & which consisted of a few biscuits. Adaba while he was eating a tall man came up & accosted him O'Donnell requested him to sit beside him & offered him a biscuit this he refused taking out a small bag which he carried he said he sat down & they began to talk in the course of conversation O'Donnell learnt that this man's name was Aboumender Delaney that he was a native of France & that he was engaged in the same pursuit with himself he the search of happiness they talked for a long time & at last agreed to travel together then rising they pursued their journey towards night fall they lay down in the open air & slept soundly till morning when they again set off & thus they continued till the day when about 2 hours after noon they approached an old castle which they entered & as they were examining it they discovered a subterraneous passage which they could not see the end of. Let us follow where this passage leads us & perhaps we may find happiness here said O'Donnell Delaney agreed & he stepped into the opening immediately a great stone was rolled to the mouth of the passage with the noise like thunder which shut out all but a single ray daylight. what is that? exclaimed O'Donnell I cannot tell replied Delaney but never mind I suppose it is only some genius playing tricks. Well it may be so returned O'Donnell and they proceeded on their way after traveling for a long time they could reckon about 2 days they perceived a silvery streak of light on the walls of the passage something like the light of the moon in a short time they came to the end of the passage and leaping out of the opening which formed they entered a new world they where at first so much bewildered by the different objects which struck

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their senses that they almost fainted but at length
 recovering they had time to see every thing around them
 they were upon the top of rock which was more
 than a thousand fathoms high, all beneath them
 was liquid Mountains tossed to & fro with horrible
 confusion & roaring & raging with
 tremendous noise & crowned with waves
 of foam all above them was a mighty firmament
 in one part covered with black clouds from which
 darted huge & terrible sheets of lightning in another
 part an immense globe of light like silver was hanging
 in the sky and several smaller globes which sparkled
 exceedingly surrounded it in a short time the darkness
 which was dreadful beyond description ceased the dark
 black clouds cleared away the silver globes vanished &
 another globe whose light was of a golden colour appeared
 it was far larger than the former & in a little time it
 became so intensely bright that they could no longer
 gaze on it so after looking around them for some time
 they pursued their journey they had travelled ^{the} ~~the~~
 way when they ^{came to} ~~came to~~ an forest the trees of which
 bore a large fruit of a deep purple colour of which they
 tasted & found it was fit for food they journeyed in this
 forest for three days on the 3 day they entered a valley
 rather a deep glen surrounded on each side by tremendous
 rocks whose tops were lost in clouds in this glen they
 continued for some time & at last came in sight of a
 mountain which rose so high that they could not see the
 summit though the sky was quite clear at the foot of
 the mountain there flowed a river of pure water bordered
 by trees which had flowers of a beautiful rose colour
 except these trees nothing was to be seen but black
 forest & huge rocks rising out of a wilderness which bore
 the terrible aspect of devastation & which stretched so far
 as the eye could reach in this desolate land no sound was
 to be heard not even the eagle or the scream of the
 Curlew but a silence like the silence of the grave reigned
 over all the face of nature unbroken except by the murmur
 of the river as it slowly ~~flowed~~ ^{ran} its course through the desert

after they had contemplated this scene some time O'Donnell
 exclaimed "ALEXANDER let us abide here what need have
 we to travel farther let us make this our place of rest I
 will replied Delaney this shall be our abode added he pointing
 to a cave at the foot of the mountain it shall be our home
 O'Donnell as they entered it in this country they remained
 for many long years & passed their time in a manner which
 made them completely happy sometimes they would
 sit upon a rock & listen to the hoarse thunder rolling through
 the sky & making the mountains echo & the descending
 with its awful voice, sometimes they would watch the
 lightning dashing across the clouds & shivering huge
 fragments of rock in its terrible passage sometimes
 they would ^{view} ~~view~~ the great glorious orb of gold sink
 behind the far distant mountains which girded the hor-
 izon & then watch the advance of grey twilight & the
 little stars coming forth in beauty & the silver moon
 arising in her splendour till the cold dews of night
 began to fall and then they would retire to their bed
 in the cave with hearts full of joy & thankfulness.
 one evening they
 were seated in this cave by a large blazing fire of
 turf which cast a lurid light to the high arched roof and
 illuminated the wall & stately pillars cut by the hand of nature
 out the stone rock with a glare that appeared strange in
 this desolate land which no fires had ever before visited except
 those ~~fiery~~ ^{fiery} flames of death which flash from
 the burning heavens when robed in the dreadful majesty of thun-
 der they were seated in this cave then listening to howling
 night wind as it swept in mournful cadence through the
 trees of the forest which ^{grew} ~~grew~~ encircled the foot of the moun-
 tain & bordered the stream which flowed round it they were quite
 silent & their thoughts were occupied by those that were
 far off & whom it was their fate most likely never more
 to behold O'Donnell was thinking of his noble master
 and his young Princess of the thousands of miles which

in this palace were thousands and tens of thousands
of faires a gem some of whom flitted lightly and among
the blazing lamps to the sound of heavenly music
which dyed a swelled in wild grandeur suited to the words they
sung -

~~It would strike them shivering to the earth
like the flash from a thunder cloud
it would quench their light & joyous mirth
and fit them for the shroud~~

~~the rising of our palaces
like visions of the deep
and the glory of their structure
no mortal voice can speak~~

~~the music of our songs
and our mighty trumpets swell
the sounding of our silver harps
no mortal tongue can tell~~

~~of us they know but little
save when the storm doth rise
and the mighty waves are tossing
against the arched sky~~

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~~of us they know but little
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and the mighty waves are tossing
against the arched sky~~

then off they see us striding

over the billows snow white foam
or hear us speak in thunder
when we stand in grandeur lone

on the darkest of the night
which veil the pearly moon
around us lightning flashing
night's blackness to illumine

carves the music of our songs
and our mighty trumpets
swell the sounding of our silver
harps no mortal tongue can tell

when they had finished their wondrous silence for about
half an hour & then the palace began slowly & gradually
to vanish till it disappeared entirely & I found myself in the place
surrounded by high mountains the fountain illuminated by
the cold light of the moon springing up in the middle of the
valley a standing close by was the old man who had conducted
me to this enchanted place he turned round & I could see
that his face had an expression of strange severity which
I had not before observed follow me he said I obeyed & we
began to ascend the mountain it would be needless to trouble
you with a repetition of all my adventures suffice it to say
that after two months time we arrived at a large temple
built of black marble the interior as well as the out-
side had a very solemn & imposing aspect being entirely
dark & I was led to an altar at the upper end of the temple
then kneeling me down on my knees he made me swear
that I would be his servant for ever this promise I faithfully
kept notwithstanding the dreadful scenes of magic which
every day of my life I was forced to be a witness

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one day he told me that he would discharge me from the oath I had taken & commanded me to leave his service I obeyed & after wandering about the world for many years I one evening laid myself down on a little bank by the roadside intending to pass the night there suddenly I felt myself raised in the air by invisible hands in a short time I lost sight of the earth and continued on my course through the clouds till I became insensible & when I recovered from my swoon I found myself lying outside this cave what may be my future destiny I know not

CHAPTER the V

When the old man had finished his tale O'Donnell & Delancy thanked him for the relation adding at the same time that they had never heard anything half so wonderful then as it was very late they all retired to rest the next morning O'Donnell awoke very early & looking round the cave he perceived the bed of lead on which the old man had lain to be empty therefore he went out of the cave the sky was covered with ~~heavy~~ clouds except those in the east whose edges were tinged with the bright rays of the ~~morning~~ sun as they strove to hide its glory with the dark veil of vapours now all beauty & radiance by the golden line of light which streaked their ~~cloudy~~ surface beneath this storm portending sky & far off to the westward ~~rose~~ two tremendous rocks whose summits were enveloped with black clouds rolling one above another with an awful magnificence ~~as~~ ~~as~~ to the land of wilderness & mountains ~~in~~ which they canopied ~~the air~~ ~~the air~~ ~~the air~~ these two rocks were a ~~great~~ ~~great~~ ~~great~~ in the chariot sat a figure the expression ~~of~~ ~~of~~ ~~of~~ of whose countenance was that of the old man armed with the majesty of a spirit O'Donnell stood at the mouth of the cave with his hand on his forehead & the old man's Delancy he related the circumstance

some years after this Alexander went out one morning to search ~~for~~ ~~for~~ ~~for~~ of the fruit on which they subsisted moon came & he had not returned evening & still no tidings of him O'Donnell began to be alarmed & set out in search of him but could no where find him one whole day he spent in wandering about the rocks and mountains and in the evening he came back to his cave weary and faint & hungry & thirty days weeks months passed away and Delancy feared O'Donnell might now be said to be truly ~~rigorous~~ ~~rigorous~~ ~~rigorous~~ he would sit on a rock for hours together and cry out Alexander Alexander but receive no answer except the distant echoing of his voice among the rocks sometimes he fancied it was another person answering him and then ~~then~~ ~~then~~ ~~then~~ he would listen earnestly till it died away then sin King into utter despair till the dews of night began to fall when he would sit till the dews of night began to fall when he would retire to his cave to pass the night in unquiet broken slumbers or in thinking of his beloved comrade whom he could never see more in one of those dreadful ~~visions~~ ~~visions~~ ~~visions~~ he took up a small parcel & opening it he saw lying before him two locks softly lying like ~~burnished~~ ~~burnished~~ ~~burnished~~ gold he gazed on them for a while & though ~~at the~~ ~~at the~~ ~~at the~~ words of those who gave them to him take this then that you may remember the ~~old~~ ~~old~~ ~~old~~ as when you dwell with only the wildness of the desert ~~the~~ ~~the~~ ~~the~~ the great eagle of the mountain he burst into a flood of tears hawking his hands ~~in~~ ~~in~~ ~~in~~ the anguish of the moment he wished that he could once more see them & the mighty warrior King their father if it cost him his life just at that instant a loud clap of thunder shook the roof of the cave a sound like the rushing of the storm was heard & a mighty genius stood before him I know thy griefs & he with a loud and terrible voice will grant it in 2 months time thou shalt return to the

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castle & since those earliest times & surrendered himself
 power O'Donnell promised that he would & instantly
 he found himself at the door of the old castle & in the
 land of his birth he pursued his journey for three days
 & on the 3rd day he arrived at the mountain which
 overlooked the city it was a beautiful evening in the
 month of September & the full moon was shedding
 her tranquil light on all the face of nature the city was
 lying in its splendour & magnificence surrounded
 by the broad stream of the Grapina the palace was
 majestically towering in the midst of it and all its
 pillars & battlements ~~seemed~~ seemed in the calm
 light of the moon as if they were transformed into
 silver by the touch of a fairy wand O'Donnell still
 not long to contemplate this beautiful scene
 but descending the mountain he soon crossed
 the fertile plain which led to the city & entering
 the gates he quickly arrived at the palace without
 speaking to any one he entered the innermost
 of the palace by a secret way with which he
 was acquainted & then going up the flight of
 steps which ~~led to the king's~~ led to the king's
 & crossing a long gallery he arrived at the king's
 private apartments the door was half open he looked
 and beheld a very handsome young man sitting at
 a reading he instantly recognised him & was going
 to step forward when the door opened & the Duke
 entered O'Donnell could contain himself no longer
 rushing in he threw himself at the feet of his Grace
 O'Donnell is this you exclaimed the Duke
 it is my most noble master & answered O'Donnell
 O'Donnell almost choking with joy the Duke
 & young ~~man~~ man instantly embraced
 him while he almost smothered them with

kisses after awhile they became tranquil & then O'Donnell
 at the request of the Duke related all his adventures since
 he parted with them not omitting the condition on which
 he was now in the palace when he had ended a loud voice
 was heard saying that he was free from his promise
 & might spend the rest of his days in his native city
 some time after this as O'Donnell was walking in the
 streets he met a gentleman who he thought he had
 seen before but could not recollect where or under what
 circumstances after a little conversation he discovered
 that he was Adierandy Delaney that he was now a
 rich merchant in the city of Paris & high in favour
 with the emperor Napoleon as may be supposed
 they were equally delighted at the discovery they ever
 after lived ~~happily~~ in the city their separate cities & so
 ends my little tale.

P. Monte August 17
 1829

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- Chap III coming to the cave manner of life at the old man
- Chap VI old man's tale
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FINIS

Preface

The persons nearest by the Chief
of the city & his sons are the
Duke of Wellington the Marquis
of Duns & Lord Mellesley
the city is the Glass town
Henry O'Donnell ~~and~~
and Alexander Delancey are
Captain Tanna not-at-home
& Monsieur Libre-to-live-in-
lonely-places

Charlotte Brontë
August the 17
1829

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A TALE BY 3

The search of CB July 28 1829 for happiness
chapter 1

NOT many years ago there lived in a certain city
a person of the name of Henry O'Donnell, in figure he was
tall of a dark complexion & searching black eye, his mind was
strong & unbending his disposition uncosiable & though res-
pected by many he was loved by few: the city where he re-
sided was very great & magnificent it was governed by a
warrior a mighty man of valour whose deeds had resound-
ed to the ends of the earth. this soldier had a son who were
at that time of the separate ages of 6 & 7 years Henry —
O'Donnell was a nobleman of great consequence in the
city & a peculiar favourite with the governor before whose
glance his stern mind would bow & at his command O'Donnell
self will would be overcome & while playing with the young
princes he would forget his usual sullenness of demeanour
the days of his childhood returned upon him & he would be
as merry as the youngest who was gay indeed. one day
at court a quarrel ensued between him & another noble
words came to blows & O'Donnell struck his opponent a
violent blow on the left cheek at this the military
King started up & commanded O'Donnell to apologise
this he immediately did, but from that hour a spell seem-
ed to have been cast over him & he resolved ~~in his mind~~
to quit the city, the evening before he put this
resolution into practice he had an interview with the
King & returned quite an altered man, before he was
stern & intractable now he was meditative & sorrowful
as he was passing the inner court of the palace he
perceived the 2 young princes at play he called them
& they came running to him. I am going far from this
city & shall most likely never see you again said O'Donnell
where are you going? I cannot tell them why do you go
away from us why do you go from your own house &
lands from this great & splendid city? you know not yet

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because I am not happy here - if you are not happy here where you have every thing for which you can wish do you expect to be happy when you are dying of hunger or thirst in a desert or longing for the society of men when you are thousands of miles of miles from any human being how do you know that that will be my case? It is very likely that it will. Well if it was I am determined to go. Well take that that you may sometimes remember when you dwell with only the wild beasts of the desert or the ~~the~~ of the ~~the~~ said they as they each gave him a curving look at their hair yes I will take it my prince I shall remember you a mighty warrior King your father even when the angel of Death has stretched forth his bony arm against me and I am within the confines of his dreary King dom the cold damp grave replied O'Donnell as the tears rushed to his eyes and he once more embraced the little prince. Al then quitted them it might be for ever -

CHAPTER THE II

THE Dawn of the next morning found O'Donnell on the summit of a High mountain which overlooked the city he had stopped to take a farewell view of the place of his nativity. all along the eastern horizon there was a rich glowing light which as it rose gradually melted into a pale blue of the sky in which just over the light there was still in the silver crescent of the moon in a short time the sun began to rise in golden glory casting his splendid radiance over all the face of nature & illuminating the magnificent city in the midst of which towering in silent grandeur there appeared the Palace where dwelt the great the mighty Prince of that great city. all around the brazen gates & massive walls of which there flowed the majestic stream of the Guadima whose Banks were bordered by splendid palaces & magnificent gardens behind them stretching for many a league were fruitful plains & ~~dark~~ forests whose ~~impenetrable~~ shade ~~seemed almost impenetrable to a single ray of light~~ while in the distance blue mountains were seen raising their heads to the sky forming a misty garb to the plains on which ~~Dahomey~~ the whole of this grand and beautiful

O'Donnell gaze was long & fixed but his last look was to the face of the King & a tear stood in his eye as he said earnestly may he be preserved from all evil may good attend him & may the chief Geni spread their broad shield of protection over him. All the time of his sojourn in this wondrous world the turning round he began to descend the mountain he pursued his way till the sun began to wane when he stopped & sitting down he took out some provisions which he had brought with him & which consisted of a few biscuits. Adaba while he was eating a tall man came up & accosted him O'Donnell requested him to sit beside him & offered him a biscuit this he refused taking out a small bag which he carried he said he sat down & they began to talk in the course of conversation O'Donnell learnt that this man's name was Aboumender Delaney that he was a native of France & that he was engaged in the same pursuit with himself he the search of happiness they talked for a long time & at last agreed to travel together then rising they pursued their journey towards night fall they lay down in the open air & slept soundly till morning when they again set off & thus they continued till the day when about 2 hours after noon they approached an old castle which they entered & as they were examining it they discovered a subterraneous passage which they could not see the end of. Let us follow where this passage leads us & perhaps we may find happiness here said O'Donnell Delaney agreed & he stepped into the opening immediately a great stone was rolled to the mouth of the passage with the noise like thunder which shut out all but a single ray daylight. what is that? exclaimed O'Donnell I cannot tell replied Delaney but never mind I suppose it is only some genius playing tricks. Well it may be so returned O'Donnell and they proceeded on their way after traveling for a long time they could reckon about 2 days they perceived a silvery streak of light on the walls of the passage something like the light of the moon in a short time they came to the end of the passage and leaping out of the opening which formed they entered a new world they where at first so much bewildered by the different objects which struck

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 to behold O'Donnell was thinking of his noble master
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in this palace were thousands and tens of thousands
of faires a gem some of whom flitted lightly and among
the blazing lamps to the sound of heavenly music
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one day he told me that he would discharge me from the oath I had taken & commanded me to leave his service I obeyed & after wandering about the world for many years I one evening laid myself down on a little bank by the roadside intending to pass the night there suddenly I felt myself raised in the air by invisible hands in a short time I lost sight of the earth and continued on my course through the clouds till I became insensible & when I recovered from my swoon I found myself lying outside this cave what may be my future destiny I know not

CHAPTER the V

When the old man had finished his tale O'Donnell & Delancy thanked him for the relation adding at the same time that they had never heard anything half so wonderful then as it was very late they all retired to rest the next morning O'Donnell awoke very early & looking round the cave he perceived the bed of lead on which the old man had lain to be empty therefore he went out of the cave the sky was covered with ~~heavy~~ clouds except those in the east whose edges were tinged with the bright rays of the ~~morning~~ sun as they strove to hide its glory with the dark veil of vapours now all beauty & radiance by the golden line of light which streaked their ~~cloudy~~ surface beneath this storm portending sky & far off to the westward ~~rose~~ two tremendous rocks whose summits were enveloped with black clouds rolling one above another with an awful magnificence ~~as~~ ~~as~~ to the land of wilderness & mountains ~~in~~ which they canopied ~~the air~~ ~~the air~~ ~~the air~~ these two rocks were a ~~great~~ ~~great~~ ~~great~~ in the chariot sat a figure the expression ~~of~~ ~~of~~ ~~of~~ of whose countenance was that of the old man armed with the majesty of a spirit O'Donnell stood at the mouth of the cave with his hand on his forehead & the old man's words were in his ears he related the circumstance

some years after this Alexander went out one morning to search ~~for~~ ~~for~~ ~~for~~ of the fruit on which they subsisted moon came & he had not returned evening & still no tidings of him O'Donnell began to be alarmed & set out in search of him but could no where find him one whole day he spent in wandering about the rocks and mountains and in the evening he came back to his cave weary and faint & hungry & thirty days weeks months passed away & Delancy feared O'Donnell might now be said to be truly ~~rigorous~~ ~~rigorous~~ ~~rigorous~~ he would sit on a rock for hours together and cry out Alexander Alexander but receive no answer except the distant echoing of his voice among the rocks sometimes he fancied it was another person answering him and then ~~then~~ ~~then~~ ~~then~~ he would listen earnestly till it died away then sin King into utter despair till the dews of night began to fall when he would sit till the dews of night began to fall when he would retire to his cave to pass the night in ~~unquiet~~ ~~unquiet~~ ~~unquiet~~ broken slumbers or in thinking of his beloved comrades whom he could never see more in one of those dreadful ~~visions~~ ~~visions~~ ~~visions~~ he took up a small parcel & opening it he saw lying before him two locks softly lying like ~~burnished~~ ~~burnished~~ ~~burnished~~ gold he gazed on them for a while & though ~~at the~~ ~~at the~~ ~~at the~~ words of those who gave them to him take this then that you may remember the ~~old~~ ~~old~~ ~~old~~ as when you dwell with only the wildness of the desert ~~the~~ ~~the~~ ~~the~~ the great eagle of the mountain he burst into a flood of tears hawking his hands ~~in~~ ~~in~~ ~~in~~ the anguish of the moment he wished that he could once more see them & the mighty warrior King their father if it cost him his life just at that instant a loud clap of thunder shook the roof of the cave a sound like the rushing of the storm was heard & a mighty genius stood before him I know thy griefs & he with a loud and terrible voice will grant it in 2 months time thou shalt return to the

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castle & since those earliest times & surrendered himself
 power O'Donnell promised that he would & instantly
 he found himself at the door of the old castle & in the
 land of his birth he pursued his journey for three days
 & on the 3rd day he arrived at the mountain which
 overlooked the city it was a beautiful evening in the
 month of September & the full moon was shedding
 her tranquil light on all the face of nature the city was
 lying in its splendour & magnificence surrounded
 by the broad stream of the Grapina the palace was
 majestically towering in the midst of it and all its
 pillars & battlements ~~seemed~~ seemed in the calm
 light of the moon as if they were transformed into
 silver by the touch of a fairy wand O'Donnell still
 not long to contemplate this beautiful scene
 but descending the mountain he soon crossed
 the fertile plain which led to the city & entering
 the gates he quickly arrived at the palace without
 speaking to any one he entered the inner court
 of the palace by a secret way with which he
 was acquainted & then going up the flight of
 steps which led to the ~~palace~~ palace
 & crossing a long gallery he arrived at the King's
 private apartments the door was half open he looked
 and beheld a very handsome young man sitting at a
 table & reading he instantly recognised him & was going
 to step forward when the door opened & the Duke
 entered O'Donnell could contain himself no longer
 rushing in he threw himself at the feet of his Grace
 O'Donnell is this you exclaimed the Duke
 it is my most noble master & answered O'Donnell
 almost choking with joy the Duke
 & young ~~prince~~ prince instantly embraced
 him while he almost smothered them with

caresses after awhile they became tranquil & then O'Donnell
 at the request of the Duke related all his adventures since
 he parted with them not omitting the condition on which
 he was now in the palace when he had ended a loud voice
 was heard saying that he was free from his promise
 & might spend the rest of his days in his native city
 some time after this as O'Donnell was walking in the
 streets he met a gentleman who he thought he had
 seen before but could not recollect where or under what
 circumstances after a little conversation he discovered
 that he was Alexander Delaney that he was now a
 rich merchant in the city of Paris & high in favour
 with the emperor Napoleon as may be supposed
 they were equally delighted at the discovery they ever
 after lived ~~happily~~ in the city their separate cities & so
 ends my little tale.

P. Monte August 17
 1829

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